

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8
♥ A 10 5
♦ K 3 2
♣ K Q 8 7 4

♠ 10 7 5

♥ K Q J 9 8 2

♦ A 9 6

♣ 3



♠ K 9 6 3 2
♥ 6 3
♦ J 10 8 4
♣ 10 5

♠ Q J 4

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 7 5

♣ A J 9 6 2

With 10 HCP and a solid 6-card suit this is an ideal DONT bid. You double and partner follows procedure by saying 2♣.

Now you follow procedure by showing your 6-card suit. You bid 2♥ and everybody passes.

West	North	East	South
1NT	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥		
All Pass			

2♥ by North
Lead: ♣10

Board 2

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 2
♥ K Q 8 3
♦ Q 6 5
♣ A J 9 4

♠ 10 7

♥ A J 9 7 4 2

♦ A 8 2

♣ K Q



♠ K 5

♥ 10

♦ K J 10 7 3

♣ 8 7 6 5 3

♠ Q J 9 8 6 4 3

♥ 6 5

♦ 9 4

♣ 10 2

West

1NT

All Pass

2♠ by South

Lead: ♥K

North

Dbl

East

Pass

South

2♠

Partner's double asks you to bid 2♣ as a relay bid so he can name his suit.

But you don't want him to bid his 6-card suit, your hand is useless unless ♠s are trumps. So ignore the relay request and bid 2♠. Everybody passes.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 8 6 5 2

♥ 10

♦ J 10 7 2

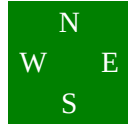
♣ A 9 6

♠ 4

♥ K Q 9 8 6 2

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 10 7 5



♠ K Q 3

♥ A 5 4

♦ A 9 4

♣ K 8 3 2

♠ A J 9 7

♥ J 7 3

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q J 4

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

Pass

Dbl

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

Lead: ♠K

In the balancing seat it is distribution that counts, not point count. With a 6-card Major suit and a singleton you should not let them play 1NT. You double.

Partner makes the relay bid of 2♣.

You bid your suit, 2♥, and everybody passes. Notice that partner had a decent hand, but could not bid over 1NT in the immediate seat.

Board 4

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 5 4

♥ A 10 7 4

♦ K 8 2

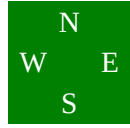
♣ 8

♠ K 2

♥ 6 3

♦ 7 5 3

♣ K J 9 6 5 3



♠ Q 6

♥ K Q 9

♦ A J 10

♣ A 10 7 4 2

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ J 8 5 2

♦ Q 9 6 4

♣ Q

West

North

East

South

Pass

Dbl

Pass

2♣

All Pass

2♣ by South

Lead: ♣8

You don't have a 6-card suit, nor do you have a 5-4 pair of suits. So even with a singleton you don't want to use DONT here. So you pass.

Partner makes a DONT double in the balancing seat.

Right now you probably have a premonition about what is going to happen next. But there really is nothing you can say other than 2♣.

Your premonition came true. Partner passes and you are left playing 2♣ with a singleton. Nobody promised that DONT would always get you to a good contract.